

ELECTION COMMISSION

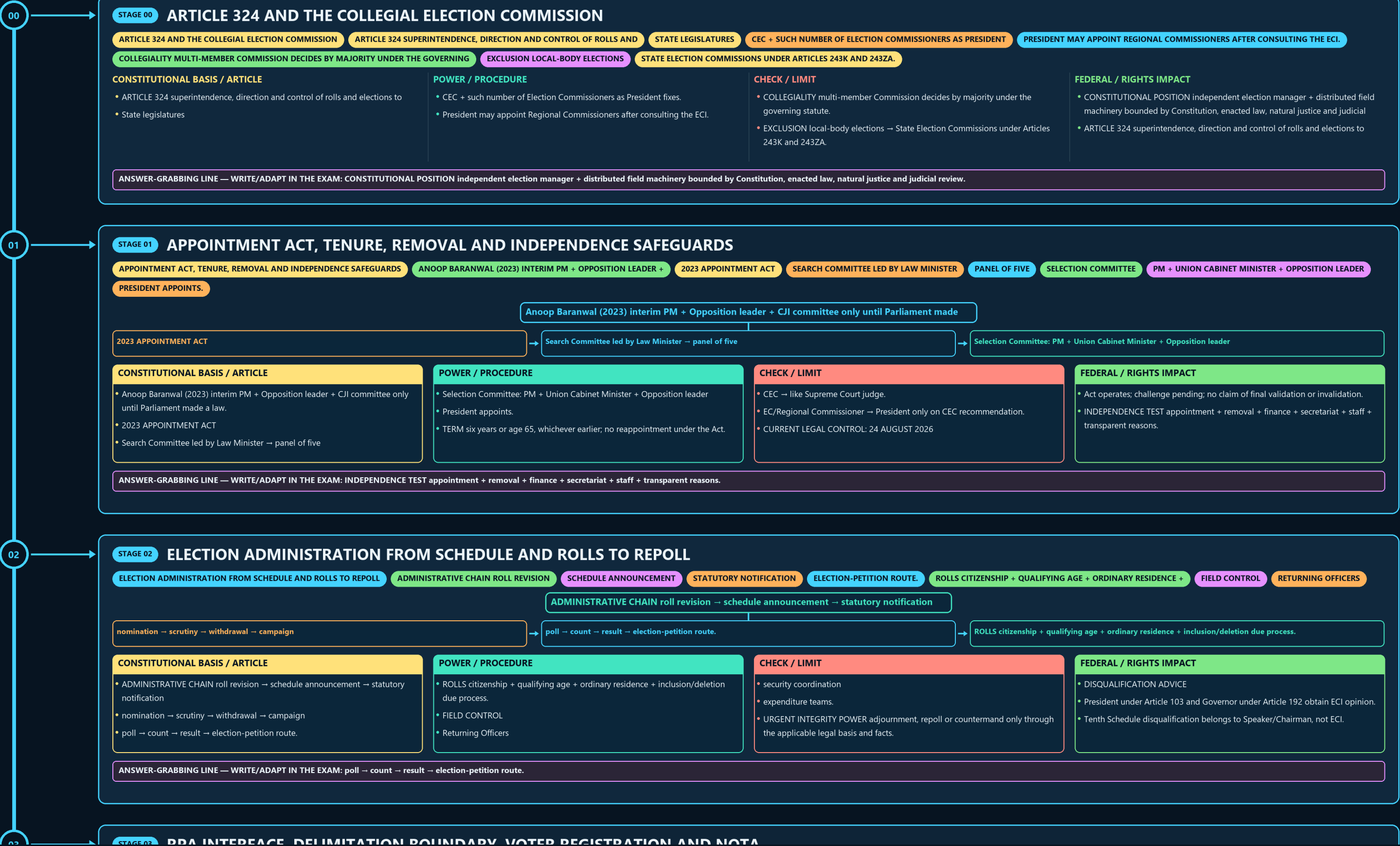
ARTICLE 324 AND THE → APPOINTMENT ACT, TENURE, REMOVAL → ELECTION ADMINISTRATION FROM SCHEDULE → RPA INTERFACE, DELIMITATION BOUNDARY → POLITICAL PARTIES, SYMBOLS AND → CAMPAIGN FINANCE, CRIMINALISATION, PAID

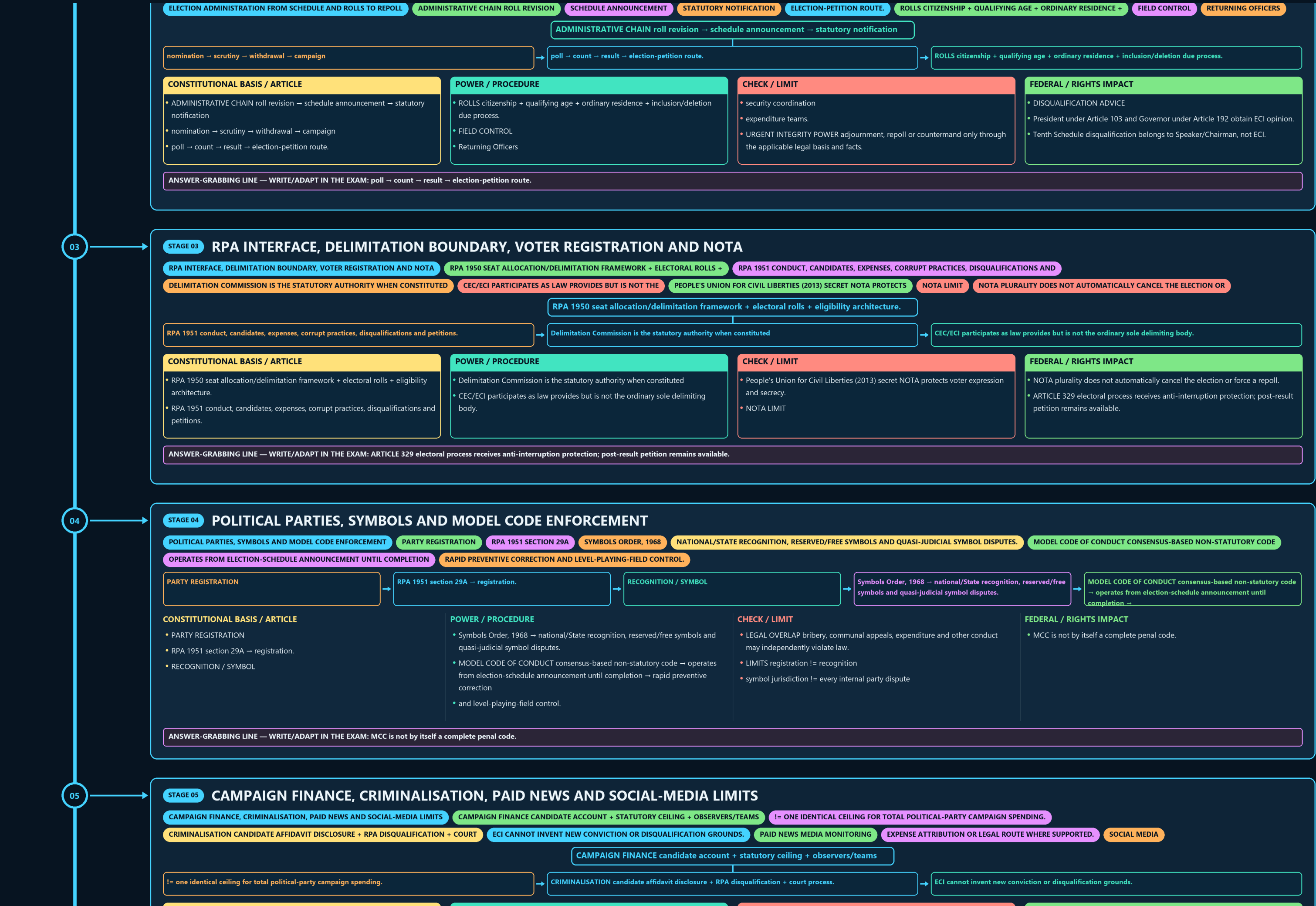
Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g4 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles





05

• RECOGNITION / SYMBOL

MODEL CODE OF CONDUCT contains based non statutory code → operates from election-schedule announcement until completion → rapid preventive correction

• and level-playing-field control.

limits regulation != recognition

• symbol jurisdiction != every internal party dispute

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MCC is not by itself a complete penal code.

05

STAGE 05

CAMPAIGN FINANCE, CRIMINALISATION, PAID NEWS AND SOCIAL-MEDIA LIMITS

CAMPAIGN FINANCE, CRIMINALISATION, PAID NEWS AND SOCIAL-MEDIA LIMITS

CAMPAIGN FINANCE CANDIDATE ACCOUNT + STATUTORY CEILING + OBSERVERS/TEAMS

!= ONE IDENTICAL CEILING FOR TOTAL POLITICAL-PARTY CAMPAIGN SPENDING.

CRIMINALISATION CANDIDATE AFFIDAVIT DISCLOSURE + RPA DISQUALIFICATION + COURT

ECI CANNOT INVENT NEW CONVICTION OR DISQUALIFICATION GROUNDS.

PAID NEWS MEDIA MONITORING

EXPENSE ATTRIBUTION OR LEGAL ROUTE WHERE SUPPORTED.

SOCIAL MEDIA

CAMPAIGN FINANCE candidate account + statutory ceiling + observers/teams

!= one identical ceiling for total political-party campaign spending.

CRIMINALISATION candidate affidavit disclosure + RPA disqualification + court process.

ECI cannot invent new conviction or disqualification grounds.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- CAMPAIGN FINANCE candidate account + statutory ceiling + observers/teams
- != one identical ceiling for total political-party campaign spending.
- CRIMINALISATION candidate affidavit disclosure + RPA disqualification + court process.

POWER / PROCEDURE

- ECI cannot invent new conviction or disqualification grounds.
- PAID NEWS media monitoring → evidence → expense attribution or legal route where supported.
- SOCIAL MEDIA / DEEPFAKES ad certification + MCC/advisories + applicable election/criminal/technology law.

CHECK / LIMIT

- ECI is not a general platform regulator or universal censor.
- Union of India v. Association for Democratic Reforms (2002)
- voter right to candidate information.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- REFORM TEST clear law + reasons + equal enforcement + rapid remedy + audit trail.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: REFORM TEST clear law + reasons + equal enforcement + rapid remedy + audit trail.

06

STAGE 06

EVM-VVPAT ARCHITECTURE AND CURRENT JUDICIAL CONTROLS

EVM-VVPAT ARCHITECTURE AND CURRENT JUDICIAL CONTROLS

POLLING CHAIN

BALLOT UNIT

CONTROL UNIT

VVPAT SLIP DISPLAY/DROP

SEALED RECORDS

COUNTING PROTOCOL.

VVPAT PURPOSE VOTER-VERIFIABLE PAPER AUDIT TRAIL, NOT A TAKE-HOME

Ballot Unit → Control Unit → VVPAT slip display/drop → sealed records → counting protocol.

POLLING CHAIN

VVPAT PURPOSE voter-verifiable paper audit trail, not a take-home ballot.

Association for Democratic Reforms v. Election Commission of India (2024) rejected paper-ballot return and universal

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- POLLING CHAIN
- Ballot Unit → Control Unit → VVPAT slip display/drop → sealed records → counting protocol.
- VVPAT PURPOSE voter-verifiable paper audit trail, not a take-home ballot.

POWER / PROCEDURE

- Association for Democratic Reforms v. Election Commission of India (2024) rejected paper-ballot return and universal 100% VVPAT counting
- added limited post-result technical safeguards.
- 2025 FOLLOW-UP candidate-requested diagnostic/check process operates within the Court's stated protocol.

CHECK / LIMIT

- ANSWER DISCIPLINE device security + roll accuracy + staff neutrality + campaign fairness
- transparent audit + reasoned judicial/administrative safeguards.
- LIMIT unsupported fraud claims and unsupported infallibility claims are both exam-unsafe.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- Association for Democratic Reforms v. Election Commission of India (2024) rejected paper-ballot return and universal 100% VVPAT counting

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT unsupported fraud claims and unsupported infallibility claims are both exam-unsafe.

07

STAGE 07

ARTICLE 324 CASE-LAW CODE: POWER, LAW, COLLEGIALITY AND RIGHTS

ARTICLE 324 CASE-LAW CODE

POWER, LAW, COLLEGIALITY AND RIGHTS

MOHINDER SINGH GILL (1977)

ARTICLE 324 IS A RESERVOIR WHERE LAW IS SILENT

A.C. JOSE (1984)

ECI FILLS GAPS BUT CANNOT ACT CONTRARY TO A

T.N. SESHAN (1995) MULTI-MEMBER COMMISSION AND EQUAL DECISION-MAKING STATUS

UNION OF INDIA V. ASSOCIATION FOR DEMOCRATIC REFORMS (2002)

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
Mohinder Singh Gill (1977)	ECI fills gaps but cannot act contrary to a field occupied by legislation/rules.	People's Union for Civil Liberties (2013) secret NOTA protects expression; it is not a binding reject option.	ECI fills gaps but cannot act contrary to a field occupied by legislation/rules.
Article 324 is a reservoir where law is silent; it cannot override enacted law.	T.N. Seshan (1995) multi-member Commission and equal decision-making status are constitutionally valid.	Anoop Baranwal (2023) → temporary appointment rule until legislation.	
A.C. Jose (1984)	Union of India v. Association for Democratic Reforms (2002) candidate disclosure serves the voter's Article 19(1)(a) right.	The VVPAT ruling is separately controlled by its full 2024 case label in Stage 06.	

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- Mohinder Singh Gill (1977)
- Article 324 is a reservoir where law is silent; it cannot override enacted law.
- A.C. Jose (1984)

POWER / PROCEDURE

- ECI fills gaps but cannot act contrary to a field occupied by legislation/rules.
- T.N. Seshan (1995) multi-member Commission and equal decision-making status are constitutionally valid.

CHECK / LIMIT

- People's Union for Civil Liberties (2013) secret NOTA protects expression; it is not a binding reject option.
- Anoop Baranwal (2023) → temporary appointment rule until legislation.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- ECI fills gaps but cannot act contrary to a field occupied by legislation/rules.

ELECTION COMMISSION • TILE 3/5 • same master rows 4726-7960 of 12686 • continues below

07

STAGE 07 ARTICLE 324 CASE-LAW CODE: POWER, LAW, COLLEGIALITY AND RIGHTS

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CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
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CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE - Mohinder Singh Gill (1977) - Article 324 is a reservoir where law is silent; it cannot override enacted law. - A.C. Jose (1984)	POWER / PROCEDURE - ECI fills gaps but cannot act contrary to a field occupied by legislation/rules. - T.N. Seshan (1995) multi-member Commission and equal decision-making status are constitutionally valid. - Union of India v. Association for Democratic Reforms (2002) candidate disclosure serves the voter's Article 19(1)(a) right.	CHECK / LIMIT - People's Union for Civil Liberties (2013) secret NOTA protects expression; it is not a binding reject option. - Anoop Baranwal (2023) → temporary appointment rule until legislation. - The VVPAT ruling is separately controlled by its full 2024 case label in Stage 06.	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT ECI fills gaps but cannot act contrary to a field occupied by legislation/rules.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Anoop Baranwal (2023) → temporary appointment rule until legislation.

08

STAGE 08 ECI-SEC BOUNDARY, REFORM PRIORITIES, TRAPS AND FINAL ANSWER SPINE

ECI-SEC BOUNDARY, REFORM PRIORITIES, TRAPS AND FINAL ANSWER SPINE ECI STATE ELECTION COMMISSION PARLIAMENT/STATE LEGISLATURE/P/VP PANCHAYAT AND MUNICIPAL ELECTIONS ARTICLE 324 ARTICLES 243K AND 243ZA NATIONAL ELECTION STATUTES PRELIMS FIREWALL CEC REMOVAL EC REMOVAL ECI ADVICE

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE - ECI STATE ELECTION COMMISSION - Parliament/State legislature/P/VP Panchayat and municipal elections - Article 324 Articles 243K and 243ZA national election statutes State local-government election law. - PRELIMS FIREWALL	POWER / PROCEDURE - CEC removal != EC removal - ECI advice != Tenth Schedule decision - ECI assists delimitation != sole delimiting authority party registration != recognition - NOTA != automatic repoll.	CHECK / LIMIT - REFORM credible plural appointment + stable secretariat/finance - equal collegial security with accountability → transparent complaint orders - cleaner rolls → faster disputes → audited technology and campaign enforcement. - MAINS SPINE	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT - Article 324 purpose → power/function → legal boundary → case-year - independence deficit → accountable reform → trust-ecosystem verdict.
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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: independence deficit → accountable reform → trust-ecosystem verdict.

09

STAGE 09 APPOINTMENT-LAW STATUS AND INSTITUTIONAL-INDEPENDENCE TEST

APPOINTMENT-LAW STATUS AND INSTITUTIONAL-INDEPENDENCE TEST ARTICLE 324 PRESIDENT APPOINTS CEC AND ECS SUBJECT TO PARLIAMENTARY LAW. ANOOP BARANWAL (2023) PM + LOP + CJI WAS AN INTERIM RULE ACT 49 OF 2023 SEARCH COMMITTEE ELIGIBLE PANEL

ARTICLE 324 → President appoints CEC and ECs subject to parliamentary law. → ANOOP BARANWAL (2023) → PM + LoP + CJI was an interim rule only until Parliament enacted a law. → ACT 49 OF 2023				
CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE - ARTICLE 324 - President appoints CEC and ECs subject to parliamentary law. - ANOOP BARANWAL (2023)		POWER / PROCEDURE - PM + LoP + CJI was an interim rule only until Parliament enacted a law. - ACT 49 OF 2023 - Search Committee → eligible panel → PM + LoP + nominated Cabinet Minister →	CHECK / LIMIT - DATED CONTROL — 28 AUGUST 2026 - Act operative; official 22 March 2024 order declined interim interference; no later official stay or merits judgment located. - REFORM TEST independence + transparency + diversity + reasoned selection + equal institutional protection.	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT PM + LoP + CJI was an interim rule only until Parliament enacted a law.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: PM + LoP + CJI was an interim rule only until Parliament enacted a law.

10

STAGE 10 ROLL, DELIMITATION AND ELECTION-DISPUTE BOUNDARIES

ROLL, DELIMITATION AND ELECTION-DISPUTE BOUNDARIES RPA 1950 SEAT ALLOCATION AND ELECTORAL-ROLL INFRASTRUCTURE; ORDINARY RESIDENCE DELIMITATION STATUTORY DELIMITATION COMMISSION; ECI PARTICIPATES BUT IS NOT RPA 1951 NOMINATIONS, CAMPAIGN, POLL, CORRUPT PRACTICES, DISPUTES AND ARTICLE 329(B) NO MID-PROCESS CHALLENGE THAT INTERRUPTS ELECTION; POST-RESULT HIGH COURT, THEN STATUTORY SUPREME COURT APPEAL.

RPA 1950 seat allocation and electoral-roll infrastructure; ordinary residence, qualifying dates, revision, claims and objections.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- ARTICLE 324 - President appoints CEC and ECs subject to parliamentary law. - ANOOB BARANWAL (2023)	- PM + LoP + CJI was an interim rule only until Parliament enacted a law. - ACT 49 OF 2023 - Search Committee → eligible panel → PM + LoP + nominated Cabinet Minister →	- DATED CONTROL — 28 AUGUST 2026 - Act operative; official 22 March 2024 order declined interim interference; no later official stay or merits judgment located. - REFORM TEST independence + transparency + diversity + reasoned selection + equal institutional protection.	PM + LoP + CJI was an interim rule only until Parliament enacted a law.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: PM + LoP + CJI was an interim rule only until Parliament enacted a law.			

10

STAGE 10

ROLL, DELIMITATION AND ELECTION-DISPUTE BOUNDARIES

ROLL, DELIMITATION AND ELECTION-DISPUTE BOUNDARIES

RPA 1950 SEAT ALLOCATION AND ELECTORAL-ROLL INFRASTRUCTURE; ORDINARY RESIDENCE

DELIMITATION STATUTORY DELIMITATION COMMISSION; ECI PARTICIPATES BUT IS NOT

RPA 1951 NOMINATIONS, CAMPAIGN, POLL, CORRUPT PRACTICES, DISPUTES AND

ARTICLE 329(B) NO MID-PROCESS CHALLENGE THAT INTERRUPTS ELECTION; POST-RESULT

HIGH COURT, THEN STATUTORY SUPREME COURT APPEAL.

RPA 1950 seat allocation and electoral-roll infrastructure; ordinary residence, qualifying dates, revision, claims and objections.

DELIMITATION statutory Delimitation Commission; ECI participates but is not ordinary sole authority.

RPA 1951 nominations, campaign, poll, corrupt practices, disputes and election petitions.

ARTICLE 329(b) no mid-process challenge that interrupts election; post-result election petition before

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

POWER / PROCEDURE

CHECK / LIMIT

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- RPA 1950 seat allocation and electoral-roll infrastructure; ordinary residence, qualifying dates, revision, claims and objections.
- DELIMITATION statutory Delimitation Commission; ECI participates but is not ordinary sole authority.

- RPA 1951 nominations, campaign, poll, corrupt practices, disputes and election petitions.
- ARTICLE 329(b) no mid-process challenge that interrupts election; post-result election petition before

- High Court, then statutory Supreme Court appeal.
- RPA 1950 seat allocation and electoral-roll infrastructure; ordinary residence, qualifying dates, revision, claims and objections.

- DELIMITATION statutory Delimitation Commission; ECI participates but is not ordinary sole authority.
- RPA 1951 nominations, campaign, poll, corrupt practices, disputes and election petitions.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ARTICLE 329(b) no mid-process challenge that interrupts election; post-result election petition before.

11

STAGE 11 SCHEDULING, REPOLL AND COUNTERMANDING LEGALITY CHAIN			
SCHEDULING, REPOLL AND COUNTERMANDING LEGALITY CHAIN	SCHEDULE ANNOUNCEMENT	ECI FIXES THE PROGRAMME UNDER ARTICLE 324 AND ELECTION	DISTURBED POLL ADJOURNMENT OR REPOLL REQUIRES THE APPLICABLE RPA/CONDUCT
CORRUPT INFLUENCE USE THE EXACT STATUTORY PROVISION; COUNTERMANDING IS	CONTROL REASONED ORDER		
SCHEDULE ANNOUNCEMENT	ECI fixes the programme under Article 324 and election law; legal notification follows the statutory	DISTURBED POLL adjournment or repoll requires the applicable RPA/Conduct Rules ground and recorded material.	CANDIDATE DEATH / BOOTH CAPTURE / CORRUPT INFLUENCE use the exact statutory provision; countermanding is
CONTROL reasoned order → natural justice where applicable → preserve election timetable → post-result petition			
CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- SCHEDULE ANNOUNCEMENT - ECI fixes the programme under Article 324 and election law; legal notification follows the statutory authority and stage.	- DISTURBED POLL adjournment or repoll requires the applicable RPA/Conduct Rules ground and recorded material. - CANDIDATE DEATH / BOOTH CAPTURE / CORRUPT INFLUENCE use the exact statutory provision; countermanding is not a free-standing political discretion.	- CONTROL reasoned order → natural justice where applicable → preserve election timetable → post-result petition for final election challenge. - SCHEDULE ANNOUNCEMENT	- ECI fixes the programme under Article 324 and election law; legal notification follows the statutory authority and stage. - DISTURBED POLL adjournment or repoll requires the applicable RPA/Conduct Rules ground and recorded material.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CONTROL reasoned order → natural justice where applicable → preserve election timetable → post-result petition for final election challenge.			

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE			
OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT	ELECTION COMMISSION + ELECTIONS & ELECTORAL REFORMS (ARTICLES 324–329)	PART A — ELECTION COMMISSION OF INDIA (ART 324)	PART B — ELECTIONS (ART 325–329)
NOT CONCERNED WITH PANCHAYAT/MUNICIPALITY POLLS	THAT'S THE STATE ELECTION COMMISSION .	CEC REMOVED ONLY LIKE A SUPREME COURT JUDGE (SPECIAL-MAJORITY	
OPTIONAL DOCTRINE / CASE		ADVANCED LIMIT	COMPARATIVE NUANCE
- Election Commission + Elections & Electoral Reforms (Articles 324–329) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE - PART A — ELECTION COMMISSION OF INDIA (Art 324) - PART B — ELECTIONS (Art 325–329) - PART C — ELECTORAL REFORMS (highlights)		- NOT concerned with panchayat/municipality polls → that's the State Election Commission . - CEC removed only like a Supreme Court judge (special-majority resolution of both Houses on proved - CEC's service conditions can't be varied to his disadvantage after appointment. - Other ECs / Regional Commissioners removed only on the CEC's recommendation .	- CAUTION: Flaws Laxmikant flags: Constitution prescribes no qualifications , no fixed term (set by law/rules), - Anoop Baranwal (2023) v. Union of India (March 2023): SC ruled the CEC/ECs be appointed by a committee of - CEC & Other ECs (Appointment, Conditions of Service and Term of Office) Act, 2023 replaced the CJI with a - CEC Gyanesh Kumar was appointed in Feb 2025 under the new Act. Status
OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.			